

QuestVille

A Newburyport social studies experience for third grade

QuestVille is a game students play in a web browser, built on the real map of Newburyport. They can walk their own street, find their own house, and visit real places around town, discovering true stories about the city as they go. It is built for a thirty minute weekly block and covers the third grade social studies you already need to teach. Nothing to install, and nothing to prepare each week.

WHAT A SESSION LOOKS LIKE

Students open a link on their Chromebook and tap their name from your class list. No passwords, nothing to set up, and they pick up wherever they left off the week before.

They then explore that week's part of town and find the places on their list. Their character is Clipper, a dog on a skateboard. At each place they read a short story and answer a question. Here is a draft of one, so you can see the length and reading level we are aiming for:

The Waterfront

Two hundred years ago, this spot was crowded with ships. Workers built them right here by the water. Sailors then took them down the Merrimack River and out to sea to trade with faraway places.

Why do you think people built the town next to the river?

THE THREE PARTS

Each is tied to the Massachusetts third grade standards, and we can show you exactly which ones.

Find Your Way	Where things are in Newburyport. Cardinal directions, the river and the coast, and what is in each part of town, including their own street and school.
How the Town Works	The city today. The police and fire stations, City Hall, the library. Who does what, why towns have a government, and how people take part.
Newburyport Then	The city's history from the 1700s on. Everyday life, fishing and farming, shipbuilding and the port, and the people who built the town.

WHAT YOU DO

- Before the unit: sign in to a teacher page and paste in your class list.
- Each week: choose which part the class is working on and share the link.
- During class: a live view shows who has found what, so you can see who needs a nudge.
- You choose when students take the short quiz at the start and end of the unit. It takes five minutes and shows what they learned.

A FEW THINGS WORTH KNOWING

- It runs in a browser on a school Chromebook. No app, and nothing for families to manage.
- Students never create a password or username. You provide the class list, and they tap their name.
- We collect a first name and their progress in the game. Nothing else. No ads, and nothing shared with anyone.

TIMELINE

We will have a working version to show you in early September, leaving time for your feedback before it reaches students. We are planning around a late October or early November start and will follow your calendar.

WHAT WE WOULD LOVE YOUR FEEDBACK ON

- Does the thirty minute structure fit the way your block actually runs?
- Is the sample story above the right reading level and length for your students?
- Is this the content you need to cover, or are we missing something important?
- What would make you call this a success at the end of the unit?